

The Honey-Cake Feast

The sunlit hills of Greece roll down to a bright blue sea, dotted with olive groves, white marble columns, and little towns where everyone knows your name. High above, hidden in the clouds of Mount Olympus, the gods watch over the world, and the hills are full of wonders: riddling sphinxes, kindly centaurs, shy satyrs, and nymphs who sing by the springs. Here a hero is not the strongest or the loudest, but the one who keeps a cool head, asks good questions, and stands by a friend. The grandest deeds are done by being brave and kind and full of ideas. Even a fearsome guardian, met with courage and a fair word, often turns out to be lonelier than it is wicked.

The answers are here. This part is for the grown-up, not for the child.

Show the matching picture in the Atlas as you reach each place.



Read aloud, slowly and warmly. Stop often to let the children answer. There are no wrong answers here, only kind new ideas to try.

Before you begin

Today the Olive Town is having a feast! For the very first time, the big gentle Cyclops is coming down from the hills to join everyone, because he is a friend now and no longer lonely. To welcome him, the town is baking the largest honey cake anyone has ever seen.

But the honey jar is empty. Old Daphne, who keeps the olive grove, calls you to her. "You two have busy hands and kind hearts," she says. "Will you help gather what we need, and bring our big friend down to the table?"

She gives you an empty jar and a warm smile. "Up here we do not feast by leaving anyone out. We share, and we always make room for one more."



What is your hero name? Are you a hero of Imagination, of Courage, or of Heart?

Stop 1 The Hill of Bees

Up in a sunny meadow live the Hill Bees, who keep the sweetest honey in all the hills. They buzz in busy circles around their hive. If you rush or grab, they will zip away.



How could you ask the bees to share? Could you move slowly and stay calm? Could you offer them some flowers first? What do you try?

When you are gentle and ask kindly, the Hill Bees hum happily and fill your jar to the brim with golden honey. "Thank you, friends," they buzz.

Stop 2 Milo's Kitchen

Back in town, Milo the baker has made an enormous honey cake. But how do you share it so that everyone gets a piece, even the huge Cyclops, who needs a very big slice?



Let us count together. How many friends are coming? How can you cut the cake so nobody is left out, and the giant gets enough too? A fair piece is not always the same size.

When you count the guests and share the cake fairly, every plate is filled, with a great big slice saved for your giant friend.

Stop 3 Fetching the Friend

You climb up to the Cyclops's cave. He is happy to see you, but shy. "A whole town?" he says, looking down at his big feet. "What if I am too big? What if they are scared of me?"



He needs a little courage. What kind thing could you say? Could you tell him he is welcome? Could you show him the slice you saved, and walk down together? What do you do?

When you cheer him on with kind words, the giant smiles all the way across his big face. He takes your hand, and down the hill you go together.

Everyone at the Table

As the sun goes down, the whole Olive Town sits at one long table under the olive trees. And right in the middle, with the biggest slice of all, sits the Cyclops, laughing with his new friends.

Nobody is left out. Every plate is full, every face is happy. High on the mountain, kind Athena smiles down at the feast.

You did it together. You were brave, you were full of ideas, and most of all, you were kind. Well done, heroes.

The Honey-Cake Feast: Rules for the Grown-Up

New to this? Read the Guide for the Grown-Up first. It explains the whole idea in two pages and you will never need it again.

You are the Game Master, which here means a few small jobs at once: storyteller, gentle referee, the children's biggest fan, and a fellow adventurer who plays along. This is a cooperative game for two or more who play together, a grown-up and one or more children, all on the same side. Nobody competes, and nobody loses. This is a warm, gentle tale about sharing and making room for everyone, and no one in it is ever truly hurt or left out.

Setting up

- Print the map. Each player puts a small figure on the Start, the Olive Town.
- This world has no magic. Instead each hero leans on one of three qualities: **Imagination** (dreaming up ideas), **Courage** (a steady heart), or **Heart** (caring for others). On the hero sheet, where it says magic, let each child write the quality they like best. Two different qualities work best together.
- Give each player five energy stars (five small tokens or bricks). They are spent and refilled during play.
- Set out a prop or two if you can: an empty jar or cup for the honey, a few buttons or beads for flowers, and a round biscuit or a paper circle for the honey cake. Anything can be anything.
- Keep your dice and the dice-band table from the back of the kit beside you.

Difficulty bands, not dice

Challenges never call for a particular die. Each one has a band: **Easy**, **Normal**, or **Hard**. When the players try something, look up the band on the kit's dice-band table, which tells you the number to meet or beat with whatever dice your family owns. Every challenge can be played with a single ordinary die.

The golden rule: here nobody loses

A failed roll is never a defeat. It is a detour to a different route. When a roll does not meet the band, the players always have a way through:

- **Spend an energy star** to gather themselves and try the idea again, or
- **Join two qualities** once per stop to pass with no roll at all (Imagination and Heart together, say, or Courage and Imagination).

Energy stars come back when the players move on to the next stop, and when they help each other. Nobody can ever run dry for long, and nobody is ever stuck.

Helping each other: the Helping Hand

At any moment one player may help another instead of acting alone. When they do, make the help roll: on a success the challenge is passed for the pair, even if the first roll missed. Helping is generous, so reward it; it also tops up an energy star. In these hills, no hero stands alone.

The Twist of Fate

At each stop, once, the players may roll for a twist and you read out the matching line. Use whichever die the dice-band table gives you for this; with a single ordinary die, read the line that matches the number rolled.

Roll	Twist of Fate
1	A friendly satyr gives you one free hint.
2	You find your courage again, and take back one energy star.
3	A favourable wind, and the next challenge is Easy.
4	Chiron the centaur passes by and nods kindly. All is well.
5	An olive branch for luck: keep one roll to use again later.
6	A burst of birdsong, and for a moment everyone feels brave.

How it ends

There is no foe in this tale. The Cyclops was once the lonely giant of the spring, but he is a friend now, and the only challenge left is a happy one: to make him feel truly welcome. The adventure is won by asking the bees kindly, sharing the cake so that everyone has enough, and giving a shy friend the courage to come to the table. Let the sharing and the welcome land; that is the whole point. See the puzzles page for the three challenges and their solutions.

The Honey-Cake Feast: Puzzles and Solutions

For your eyes, not the children's. Each stop lists its band, what the players need to work out, the intended solution, and a gentle fallback so a stuck child always moves forward. More than one good idea should work; reward fresh ideas and kindness over the "right" answer.

Stop 1: The Hill of Bees (Easy)

The challenge. The Hill Bees keep the sweetest honey, but they will only share with someone who comes gently. The players need to fill the empty jar.

Intended solution. This is a Heart and Observation moment. The kind move is to slow down and stay calm, not to swat or snatch: approach softly, offer the bees a few meadow flowers, and ask politely. Happy bees fill the jar themselves.

Fallback. If the children rush and the bees scatter, have **Bramble the Satyr** show them how to hum a low, friendly note, or let a player spend an energy star to calm everyone down. Asking kindly always works, and tops up an energy star.

Stop 2: Milo's Kitchen (Normal)

The challenge. Milo's honey cake must be shared so that every guest at the feast gets a piece and nobody is left out, including the very large Cyclops.

Intended solution. This is a Maths and Heart moment. Count the guests together (a handful of townsfolk, Daphne, Milo, the two heroes, and the giant). Cut a slice for each, and remember that fair does not mean identical: the giant is ten times the size, so he needs a much bigger slice, while the smallest child is happy with a small one. Any plan where everyone has enough is a success.

Fallback. If the counting feels hard, have Daphne count the guests aloud on her fingers, or let the children line up one biscuit or pebble per guest and match them to the slices. Getting there with help still counts as a full success and tops up an energy star.

Stop 3: Fetching the Friend (Normal)

The challenge. The Cyclops is shy to come down to a whole townful of people. He fears he is too big, or that the townsfolk will be afraid of him. The players must give him the courage to come.

Intended solution. This is a Heart and Courage moment. Any honest, warm reassurance works: telling him plainly that he is wanted, reminding him that the town are his friends now, showing him the grand slice saved just for him, or offering to walk down at his side. Kindness, not any plan, carries this stop.

Fallback. If the children are unsure what to say, have the giant ask quietly, "Are you really sure there is room for me?" A single kind word is enough, and down the hill he comes.

The ending

There is no battle and no loser. When the honey is gathered, the cake is shared, and the giant takes his seat, the whole **Olive Town** feasts together under the olive trees with nobody left out, and kind **Athena** smiles down from the mountain. The heroes have won the only way anyone wins here, by being brave, kind, and full of ideas.

Wander and Tales

Tale Book

<https://github.com/agigante80/wander-and-tales>

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Here nobody loses. If a try does not work, find another way.